

pinnacle of prewar Southern society—life as a wealthy cotton planter.

Forrest was as determined in the pursuit of love as he was in “business.” At age 24, he rescued a mother and daughter after their buggy broke down crossing a river. The girl’s name was Mary Ann Montgomery. Forrest asked permission to visit. On his first call, he proposed to Mary Ann. She agreed on the third visit. However, her uncle and guardian, a Presbyterian minister, knew Forrest and protested, “Why, Bedford, I couldn’t consent. You cuss and gamble, and Mary Ann is a Christian girl.” Forrest replied, “I know it, and that’s just why I want her.” Weeks later, the uncle himself married them. The marriage was lasting.